

Where people work: small vs large firms

Employment shares by enterprise size for the United States, all 50 states + D.C., and metropolitan areas. Primary cut is the SBA small-business threshold (<500 employees). No market sizing. No recommendation.

Definition (SUSB employment)

Mid-March payroll employment at employer establishments, classified by the employment size of the enterprise (firm), not the establishment. Excludes nonemployers, most government, and most of agriculture. All figures RETRIEVED from Census SUSB 2022 (US, state, and MSA same vintage; MSA table revised 2025-07-22).

Large firms (500+) employ 54.1% of U.S. payroll workers; small firms hold 45.9%

45.9%

Employment at firms <500

54.1%

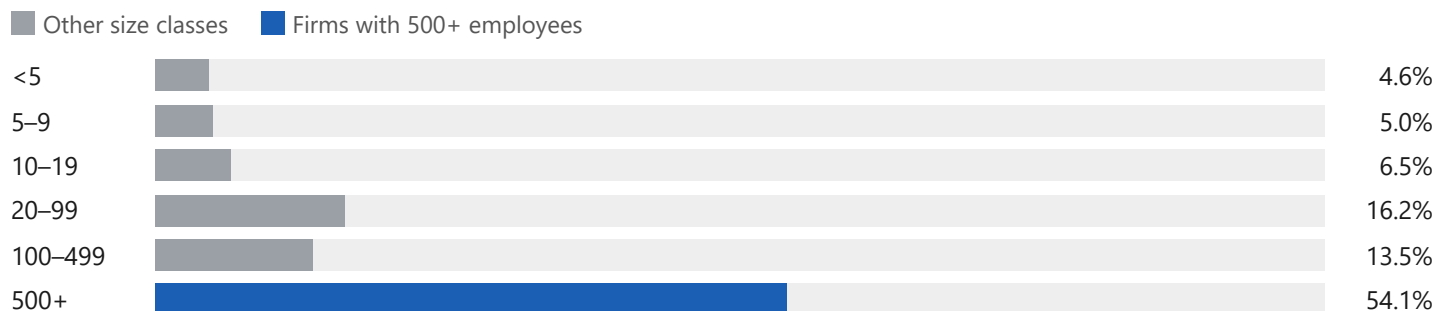
Employment at firms 500+

135.7M

Total SUSB employment

Counts: 62,250,556 at <500 · 73,497,851 at 500+ · total 135,748,407 · Source: Census SUSB 2022, US all-industry enterprise size · <https://www.census.gov/data/datasets/2022/econ/susb/2022-susb.html>

The 500+ class alone is more than half of U.S. employment

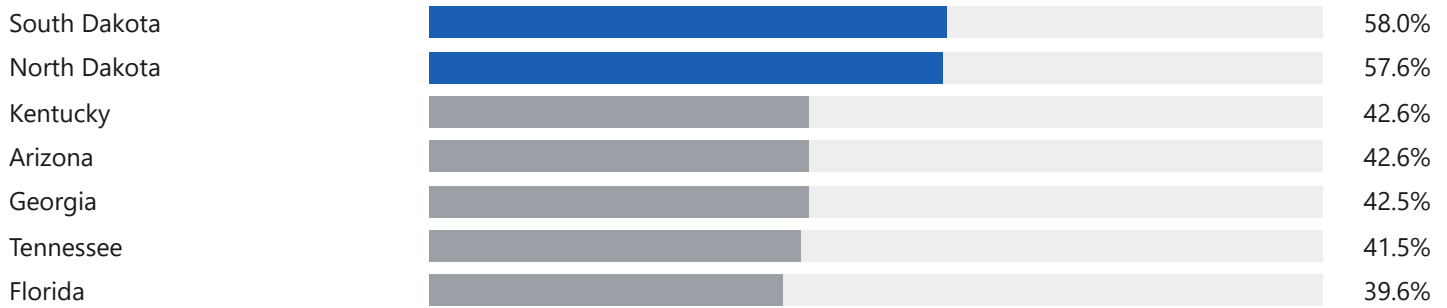


Share of U.S. SUSB employment by enterprise size class · 2022 · mutually exclusive classes sum to 100% · Source: Census SUSB detailed employment sizes

Small-firm employment share spans 26.7 points across states — 66.3% in Montana to 39.6% in Florida

Ranked by share of employment at firms with <500 employees. U.S. average is 45.9%. Chart shows the five highest and five lowest; full set of 51 (states + D.C.) is in the table.





Employment share at firms <500 · top/bottom 5 of 51 · dashed line = US 45.9% · Montana base 398,871 jobs; Florida base 9,628,867 · Source: Census SUSB 2022

All states + D.C., sorted by small-firm employment share

State	Share <500	Share 500+	Total employment	Employment <500
Montana	66.3%	33.7%	398,871	264,567
Wyoming	65.2%	34.8%	208,024	135,636
Vermont	62.1%	37.9%	254,471	157,959
South Dakota	58.0%	42.0%	373,863	216,705
North Dakota	57.6%	42.4%	342,345	197,212
Idaho	56.0%	44.0%	689,589	386,078
Maine	54.5%	45.5%	533,151	290,518
Alaska	54.2%	45.8%	257,462	139,534
Louisiana	54.1%	45.9%	1,644,036	889,431
Oregon	53.4%	46.6%	1,666,806	889,528
New Mexico	53.3%	46.7%	639,118	340,706
Rhode Island	51.1%	48.9%	439,021	224,480
Oklahoma	50.8%	49.2%	1,390,468	706,906
Delaware	50.6%	49.4%	424,303	214,539
New Hampshire	50.3%	49.7%	615,249	309,420
Hawaii	49.6%	50.4%	507,390	251,556
D.C.	49.1%	50.9%	527,355	259,181
Kansas	48.9%	51.1%	1,225,232	599,134
New Jersey	48.8%	51.2%	3,813,702	1,861,009
Washington	48.7%	51.3%	2,978,277	1,451,617
Colorado	48.6%	51.4%	2,481,196	1,206,660
Connecticut	48.1%	51.9%	1,508,634	726,097
Wisconsin	48.0%	52.0%	2,600,303	1,247,875
Maryland	47.9%	52.1%	2,436,501	1,167,051
Michigan	47.7%	52.3%	3,939,076	1,879,244
Nebraska	47.5%	52.5%	890,050	422,756

State	Share <500	Share 500+	Total employment	Employment <500
West Virginia	47.4%	52.6%	540,468	256,281
California	47.4%	52.6%	16,032,440	7,595,688
Mississippi	47.0%	53.0%	944,580	444,113
New York	46.6%	53.4%	8,429,776	3,932,389
Arkansas	46.1%	53.9%	1,089,044	501,512
Iowa	46.0%	54.0%	1,386,299	637,557
Alabama	46.0%	54.0%	1,777,657	816,850
Virginia	45.9%	54.1%	3,494,956	1,602,868
Minnesota	45.8%	54.2%	2,732,522	1,252,842
Utah	45.4%	54.6%	1,521,640	690,069
Pennsylvania	45.2%	54.8%	5,584,830	2,526,466
Nevada	45.0%	55.0%	1,286,578	578,767
Massachusetts	44.7%	55.3%	3,396,919	1,516,837
Missouri	44.4%	55.6%	2,564,383	1,139,031
Texas	44.4%	55.6%	11,507,642	5,108,008
North Carolina	44.2%	55.8%	4,106,761	1,815,569
Ohio	43.8%	56.2%	4,963,808	2,175,029
Illinois	43.7%	56.3%	5,533,883	2,420,971
Indiana	43.2%	56.8%	2,875,908	1,241,838
South Carolina	42.9%	57.1%	2,013,315	863,326
Kentucky	42.6%	57.4%	1,667,694	710,613
Arizona	42.6%	57.4%	2,787,701	1,186,389
Georgia	42.5%	57.5%	4,249,362	1,806,632
Tennessee	41.5%	58.5%	2,846,881	1,182,437
Florida	39.6%	60.4%	9,628,867	3,813,075

Sorted descending by <500 share · percentages to 1 decimal; counts from SUSB · Source: Census SUSB 2022 US & states detailed employment sizes

Metro median small-firm share is 49.8% — above the U.S. 45.9% — and the extremes are mostly smaller metros

45.9%

U.S. <500 share

49.8%

Metro median <500 share

387

Metro Areas in SUSB file

Among 387 Metropolitan Statistical Areas, the median <500 employment share is 49.8%, about 4 points above the national figure (national includes non-metro employment). Extremes are shown with employment

counts so a tiny metro cannot be mistaken for a national fact. Full MSA file (metros + micros): Analysis/small-large-employment/out/msa_employment_by_firm_size.csv

Highest small-firm shares (Metro Areas)

Metro Area	Share <500	Total emp.	Emp. <500
Bozeman, MT	74.6%	56,303	41,994
Santa Cruz-Watsonville, CA	70.1%	78,616	55,091
Kingston, NY	69.4%	43,813	30,389
St. George, UT	69.2%	67,024	46,403
Missoula, MT	68.1%	53,147	36,217
Bellingham, WA	68.0%	78,565	53,391
Fairbanks-College, AK	67.9%	25,941	17,601
Barnstable Town, MA	67.8%	76,094	51,591
Hilton Head Island-Bluffton-Port Royal, SC	66.7%	67,170	44,816
Bend, OR	66.5%	87,450	58,127

Lowest small-firm shares (Metro Areas)

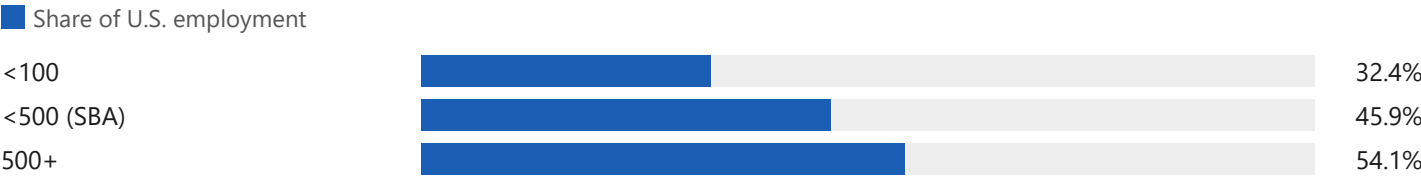
Metro Area	Share <500	Total emp.	Emp. <500
Rochester, MN	35.7%	118,610	42,318
Durham-Chapel Hill, NC	35.9%	294,892	105,841
Bloomington, IL	37.0%	74,674	27,617
San Jose-Sunnyvale-Santa Clara, CA	37.0%	1,147,117	424,355
Columbus, IN	37.5%	45,508	17,062
Ithaca, NY	37.6%	48,098	18,068
Spartanburg, SC	37.6%	151,851	57,078
Hinesville, GA	37.6%	14,855	5,589
Morgantown, WV	38.1%	55,620	21,174
Elkhart-Goshen, IN	38.4%	143,423	55,067

Metro Areas only (Micro Areas excluded from this exhibit) · SUSB 2022 MSA by 3-digit NAICS, all-industry · Source: Census SUSB datasets (MSA revised 2025-07-22)

Charter footprint metros

Not applied. Repo sources state Charter serves 41 states (~58–59M passings) but do not list the 41 states or Spectrum service metros. To subset these tables to the footprint, need an official state list and/or MSA list from a filing or Spectrum coverage source.

Moving the cutoff from <500 to <100 drops the “small” share from 45.9% to 32.4% — most employment is still at firms with 100+ workers



U.S. employment shares at alternative enterprise-size cutoffs · <100 = sum of <5, 5–9, 10–19, 20–99 · <100 employment 43,926,885 · Source: Census SUSB 2022

The SBA <500 cut puts nearly half of employment on the “small” side. A <100 cut moves the story: only about one-third of payroll employment is at firms under 100. The binary headline is cutoff-sensitive; the size-class bars above are not.

What this changes for the corporate → consumer channel

Link to the benefits-analogy draft — not a re-litigation

The analogy canvas concludes the corporate sale matters for consumer Internet only when the employer is a household-provisioning channel. This employment split says where that channel's workforce sits: nationally, 45.9% of payroll jobs are at firms under 500 and 54.1% at 500+. A channel that only works at large enterprises leaves out nearly half of employment; one that only works at small firms leaves out the majority. State and metro shares swing widely (Montana 66.3% vs Florida 39.6%; metro median 49.8%), so the mix of employer sizes — and therefore how much of local employment a given firm-size play can reach — is geography-dependent. This does not size a market or pick a course of action.

Sources and reproducibility

All inputs RETRIEVED. Census Bureau Statistics of U.S. Businesses (SUSB) 2022 Annual Datasets by Establishment Industry — Data by Enterprise Employment Size. US/state: `us_state_naics_detailedsizes_2022.txt`. MSA: `msa_3digitnaics_2022.txt`. Enterprise size codes: `enterprise_codes_2017.txt`. Script: `Analysis/small-large-employment/build_susb_employment_shares.py`. Outputs: `Analysis/small-large-employment/out/*.csv`. No cells imputed; no prior repo figure superseded (none committed on firm-size employment shares).